Rian Kawahara

Software Engineer / Solutions Engineer

Tokyo, JP · riankawahara.github.io · GitHub · LinkedIn

Bilingual (JP-native / EN-native) full-stack engineer, end-to-end executor in fast-moving startup environments. Lead customer-facing technical deployments for Japanese enterprises — LINE × HubSpot systems shipped to 10+ clients (JTB Asia Pacific, KOMEHYO) plus a US-HQ global tech enterprise pilot I solo-built and led kickoff for. Bilingual bridge on cross-border engagements (Klaviyo, Hububble Taiwan, One Education Group). Build generative-AI PoCs end-to-end (MEJORA AI Survey with OpenAI, Devin CVE Loop with observability, Slack → Devin → Jira automation), backed by a Data Science–heavy CS degree emphasizing model evaluation and statistical rigor.

EXPERIENCE

Consultant · Appian 2026-10 – Present

Consultant delivering enterprise process automation solutions on the Appian low-code platform.

Software Engineer / Solutions Engineer · Little Help Agency LLC 2025-04 – 2026-10

One of three engineers building Lumo.cx, a LINE × CRM messaging platform, and maintaining its predecessor, Little Help Connect. Led arbo (the internal ops console), was the sole engineer on the mobile app through App Store launch, and worked directly with customers and prospects on integrations, deployments, security reviews, and technical sales. Tech stack: React, Vite, TypeScript, Kotlin, Spring WebFlux, Node.js, GCP (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub), PostgreSQL

Lumo.cx Product Engineering

- Among the main frontend contributors on Lumo in my first 8 months (React / Vite / TypeScript), with growing backend contributions in Kotlin / Spring WebFlux
- Implemented UI architecture and core product features based on Figma designs, building reusable component patterns and scalable screen structures using React / TypeScript
- Built a collaborative workflow memo system (Figma-style commenting), including frontend interactions and backend APIs for positioning, threading, and updates
- Developed backend features for messaging workflows, including broadcast management (duplication, folder organization, sender configuration) and segment operations
- Shipped workflow action features in Lumo's workflow execution system that integrate with external services (HubSpot, webhooks)
- Sole engineer on the Lumo mobile app (React Native / Expo, 94% of commits): moved the app inherited from Little Help Connect onto Lumo's backend API and owned the App Store release to all Lumo users end to end — ran the EAS / TestFlight pipeline (19 builds) and got the app through Apple App Review by tracing five rejections in a row to a conflict between guideline 4.8 and Sign in with Apple's rules, then fixing it by turning social login off with a feature flag and removing an entitlement a dependency kept adding back. The app is live on the App Store

arbo — Internal Ops Console

- Lead engineer on arbo, Lumo's internal ops console for CS, sales, and finance (React / TanStack Router + Kotlin / Spring WebFlux) — wrote the admin API design proposal and was the main author on both frontend (77% of commits) and backend: customer and contract management, a sales-goal dashboard with net MRR / new orders / upsell / churn drill-downs, and HubSpot-linked customer pages
- Built arbo's HubSpot deal pipeline: HMAC-verified, replay-protected deal webhooks that create customers automatically, sync deal stages, and create draft contracts when a deal is won — plus a backfill of existing deals
- Built an hourly alert engine with staff-configurable rules and thresholds, duplicate suppression, and Slack / email notifications, so CS catches stalled onboarding and broken LINE credentials without asking engineering
- Hardened arbo's security: replaced an API token bundled into the client with a same-origin Cloudflare proxy plus Google sign-in checked against a server-side staff allowlist that fails closed

Enterprise Customer Delivery & Support

- Designed and implemented LINE Group → HubSpot Company sync, adopted by 10+ clients including JTB Asia Pacific and KOMEHYO, enabling structured CRM mapping from messaging platforms
- Took a major enterprise opportunity with a US-headquartered global tech company from first contact to PoC: joined the initial sales calls, scoped integration feasibility, and prepared the security documentation for their internal security review before handing the commercial side to sales — then solo-built the PoC (a CSV data ingestion system mapping external candidate / ATS data into LINE-driven follow-up workflows, plus a new property management surface) and led customer kickoff / onboarding for a multi-agency Japan deployment
- Resolved 30+ cross-team technical issues impacting onboarding and system reliability, accelerating deployment speed for new clients
- Handled enterprise clients' security check sheets (セキュリティチェックシート) for Little Help Connect and Lumo — translated system architecture into accurate JP-language answers on data storage / encryption / access control / auth flows / third-party dependencies to satisfy each client's internal security review process
- Covered technical support during a period of support-team absence (alongside core engineering duties) — resolved 10+ customer tickets solo via discovery calls and diagnostic queries against GCP + HubSpot logs, including unblocking a partner agency's Little Help Connect deployment where a long-standing critical issue had stalled their LINE Official Account workflow setup for an end client

Customer-Facing Demos & Cross-Border

- Represented Lumo as a bronze sponsor at LINE Yahoo Hello Friends 2026, engaging ~20 prospects in product demos and bilingual technical Q&A at the booth — ~10 qualified leads generated over two days
- Delivered live product demo at Meet Lumo!, showcasing an AI-native messaging × CRM platform to 30+ stakeholders and external partners, demonstrating end-to-end workflows and driving product understanding

- Delivered a tailored Little Help Connect demo to the Head of Operations at One Education Group (international education-agency client) focused on their agency-specific use case — engagement contributed to closing the deal
- Provided technical support for Hububble, a HubSpot Solutions Partner, during their rollout in Taiwan, working across teams to ensure successful integration and adoption
- Served as bilingual technical representative in cross-border meetings with Klaviyo, a major US B2C SaaS provider
- Joined an executive dinner between Klaviyo and Little Help Agency as bilingual facilitator — ensuring precise cross-language communication and contributing to strategy discussions on Klaviyo's Japan go-to-market via LINE, partner-led growth, and how the two companies could collaborate effectively

System Thinking & Internal Tooling

- Participated in architecture planning for large-scale messaging and CRM integrations
- Contributed to AI-to-AI integration PoCs with JTB, a major enterprise travel provider
- Built an internal Slack → Devin → Jira automation that turns bug mentions into tracked Jira tickets, improving project-management hygiene around bug capture and triage

Software Engineer Intern · Little Help Agency LLC 2025-03 – 2025-04

Proof-of-concept system for surfacing upsell-timing signals from user behavior, with HubSpot integration for contact sync.

- Built proof-of-concept system for surfacing upsell-timing signals from user sign-ups and early in-app activity
- Implemented HubSpot contact-sync flows (OAuth, contact creation) tied to user lifecycle events
- Developed backend services (Kotlin, PostgreSQL) and frontend components for capturing and visualizing user activity
- Collaborated in design discussions to validate product feasibility and integration strategy

Software Engineer Intern · MEJORA Corporation 2024-04 – 2024-08

Engineering intern on a four-person early-stage team building generative-AI products — worked directly with the CEO across product direction, technical research, and implementation, and built the AI demo products the CEO used in client pitches. Tech stack: React, Firebase, OpenAI API.

- Proposed product directions based on implementation proposals and analysis results
- Scraped market research data using Selenium and Hugging Face
- Analyzed scraped data with pandas
- Created demo mockups using Figma
- Researched necessary tech stacks and technologies for building the demo
- Led the implementation of the survey creation app demo product
- Implemented the generative AI-powered survey creation app demo (React, Firebase)

Software Engineer Intern · Diamondhead Corporation 2023-12 – 2024-02

Worked as a software developer on the Feature Improvement Team (~10 members). Tech stack: HTML, CSS, JS, Django, and PostgreSQL. The SaaS is a centralized e-commerce management platform handling clients' products across multiple e-commerce platforms (e.g. Amazon, ZOZOTOWN).

- Improved the word count feature to display accurate word counts across two different input modes
- Updated the user account modification flow to apply changes immediately, replacing the original version that relied on stale cache data
- Redesigned the product image position editing mode button, changed the default behavior, and implemented adjustable settings configurable to client preferences
- Wrote test specifications for the developed software so colleagues could test it
- Reviewed colleagues' test specifications and verified code for release
- After project completion, presented progress to the team and summarized the new features that had been implemented

EDUCATION

Monash University

Bachelor in Computer Science

LICENSES & CERTIFICATIONS

HubSpot Sales Hub Software Certified · HubSpot Academy May 2026

app-na2.hubspot.com/academy/achievements/ln051xd8/en/1/rian-kawahara/hubspot-sales-hub-software

HubSpot Inbound Certified · HubSpot Academy May 2026 · Expires Jun 2028

app-na2.hubspot.com/academy/achievements/7cplz67j/en/1/rian-kawahara/inbound

Klaviyo Practitioner Certificate · Klaviyo May 2026

credential.klaviyo.com/9c29e367-81c6-4e2e-9f54-4700c05a20ed#acc.Dd8sb9RB

LINE Official Account Basic · LY Corporation Jul 2025

riankawahara.github.io/certifications/LINEYahoo_Marketing_Skill_Badge_Certificate.pdf

SKILLS

AI / Python: Python, OpenAI API, LangChain (explored), Devin API, Claude Code, Jupyter, pandas, Selenium, prompt design, agent orchestration · **Frontend:** React, Vite, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, HTML5, CSS3 · **Backend:** Kotlin, Spring WebFlux, Node.js / Express, Django · **Data & Infrastructure:** PostgreSQL, Oracle SQL, Firebase, Docker, GCP (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub) · **Platforms & Integrations:** HubSpot, LINE, Klaviyo · **Data Science / Statistics:** R, Vega-Lite, Tableau, tree-family classifiers (RF / Boosting / Bagging), regression + confidence intervals, star/snowflake schemas, SCD strategies · **Mobile / Design:** Swift, Figma

LANGUAGES

English: Native · **Japanese:** Native / Bilingual

AWARDS

Business Award Winner · Tokyo Open Data Hackathon 2024 (Tokyo Metropolitan Government Digital Services Bureau) Oct 2024

Carbon credit acquisition support service using generative AI